StoryCast

Research & Planning Document

Project: StoryCast — Mental health, understood through stories

Prepared by: Yonas Getachew Dejene

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Quick Links

Deliverable	Link
GitHub Repository	View project codebase on GitHub
Sitemap	View sitemap on Lucidchart
Wireframes	View wireframes in Lucidchart
High-Fidelity Mockups	View Figma Prototype

1. Project Overview

1.1 About StoryCast

StoryCast is an accessible mental health storytelling microsite designed to help visitors understand mental health conditions through clear, respectful educational stories and accessible audio/video content.

The project aims to make mental health information easier to explore through a combination of storytelling, readable educational content, captions, transcripts, and links to trusted resources.

1.2 Project Objectives

The main objectives of StoryCast are to:

- Present mental health information in a clear, respectful, and approachable format.
- Use multimedia storytelling to support different ways of accessing information.
- Make the website accessible to people using keyboards, assistive technologies, captions, and transcripts.
- Provide a responsive experience across desktop, tablet, and mobile devices.
- Demonstrate semantic HTML5, maintainable Sass architecture, responsive CSS, and WCAG AA accessibility considerations.

1.3 Intended Audience

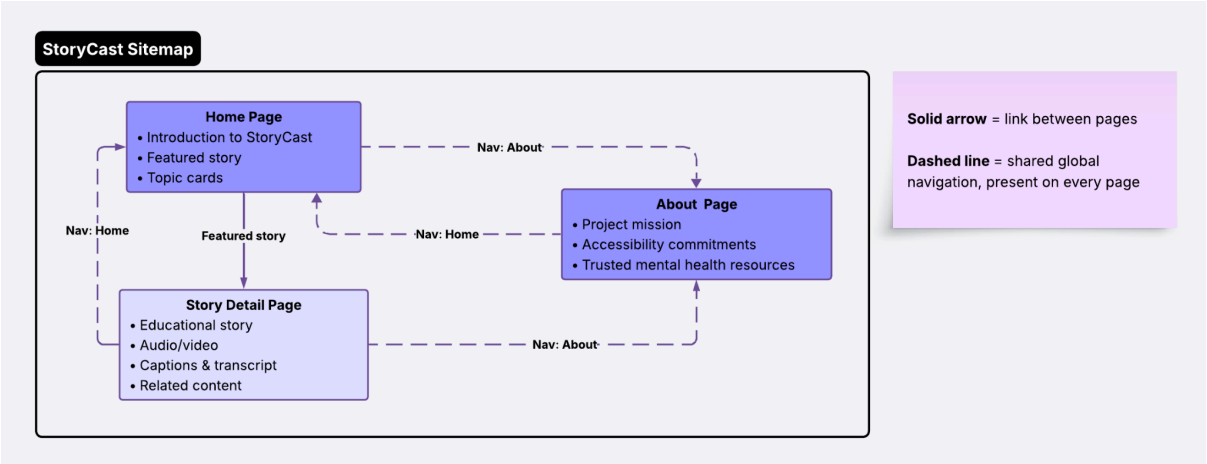
StoryCast is intended for people interested in learning about mental health, including students, families, and members of the general public. The content is educational and is not intended to diagnose conditions or replace professional advice.

2. Information Architecture

2.1 Sitemap

The sitemap defines the three-page structure of StoryCast and illustrates how visitors can navigate between the pages.

Sitemap diagram:



Link to the sitemap: Lucidchart Sitemap Link

2.2 Page Structure

Home (index.html**)** — Introduces StoryCast, presents the featured story, and previews future topics.

Story Detail (story/understanding-schizophrenia.html**)** — Presents the featured educational story, its audio/video content, captions, transcript, article content, and trusted sources.

About (about.html**)** — Explains the project's mission, accessibility commitments, and approach to responsible mental health storytelling.

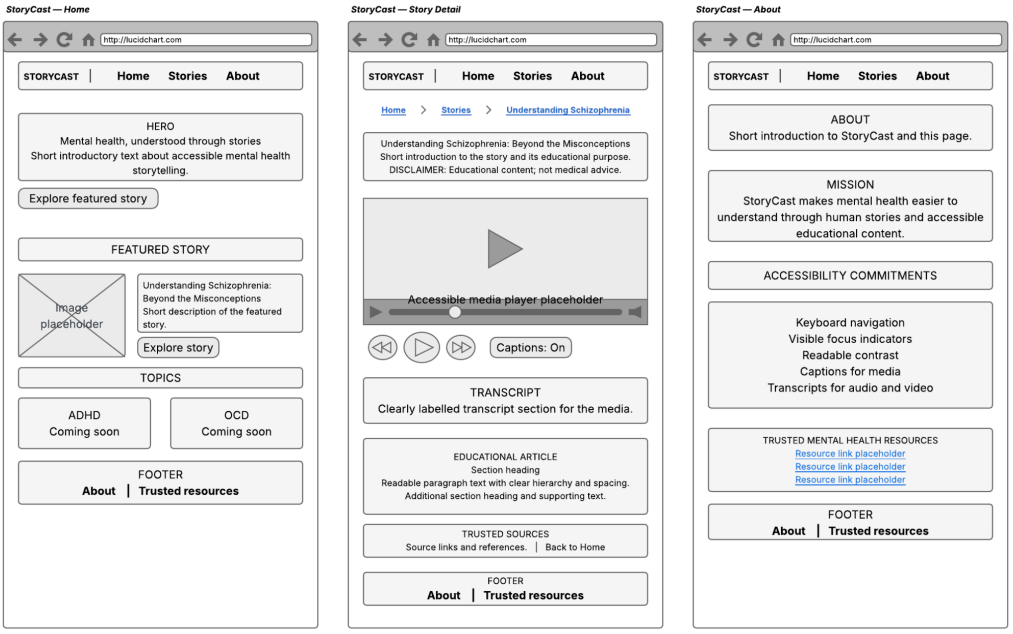
2.3 Navigation Rationale

The three-page structure keeps the microsite focused and easy to understand. The Home page acts as the main entry point, the featured story provides the primary content experience, and the About page explains the project's purpose and accessibility approach.

Consistent navigation across the pages helps visitors move between sections without having to learn a different navigation structure on each page.

3. Low-Fidelity Wireframes

Wireframes establish the content hierarchy, page sections, and approximate layout before visual styling is applied. They help identify missing content and inconsistent page structures early in the design process.



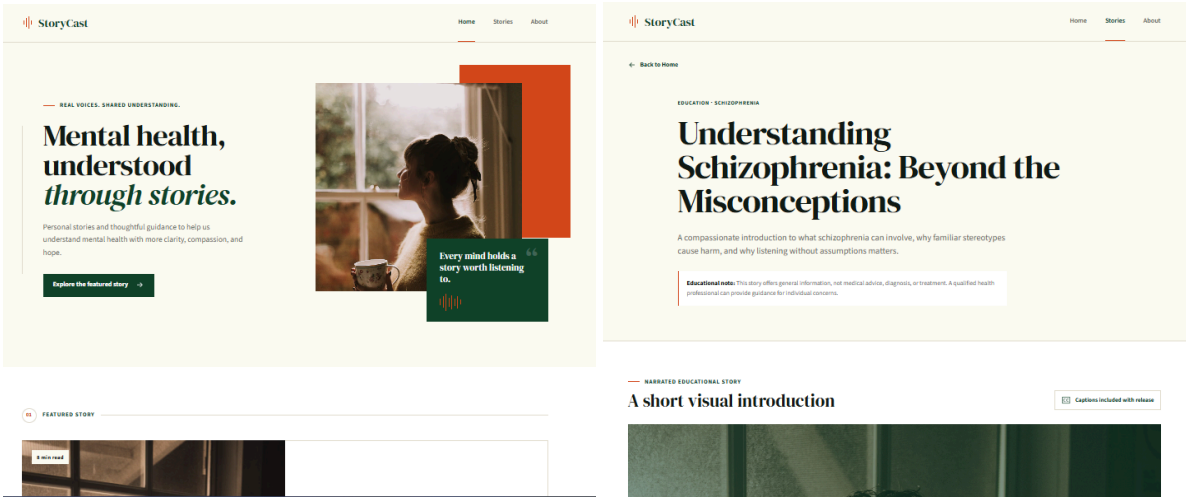
Link to wireframes: [Lucidchart Wireframes Link]

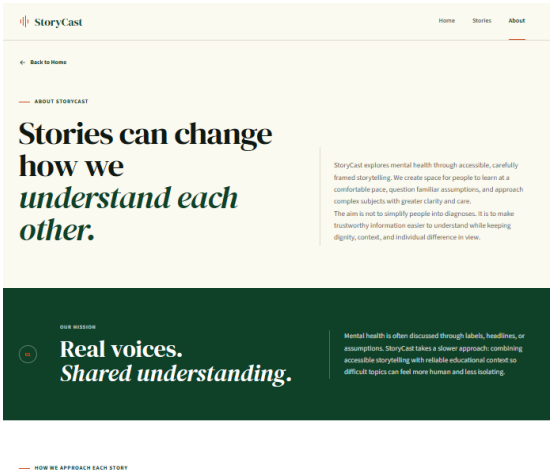
4. High-Fidelity Mockups

High-fidelity mockups have established the visual direction of StoryCast, including typography, colors, spacing, navigation, cards, media controls, and responsive layout considerations.

The mockups are created in Figma after the wireframes have been reviewed.

Links to Mockups: [Figma Prototype Link]





5. Design and Accessibility Rationale

5.1 Visual Design

StoryCast uses a clean, readable visual style built around a warm cream background, forest green as the primary color, and orange as an accent. Dark text, muted secondary text, and subtle borders help maintain a clear visual hierarchy across all three pages. Consistent typography, spacing, navigation, and reusable content patterns create a cohesive experience.

The color palette and typography are documented to maintain visual consistency during development and to support readability and accessible contrast. The selected colors are applied consistently to navigation, buttons, headings, content sections, and interactive elements.

5.2 Responsive Design

The layouts adapt to different screen sizes using CSS Grid, Flexbox, and responsive styling. Content should remain readable and usable on small screens without unnecessary horizontal scrolling.

At least one CSS container query has been used to demonstrate component-level responsive behavior.

5.3 Accessibility

Accessibility has been considered throughout the design and implementation process, including:

- Semantic HTML landmarks and a logical heading hierarchy.
- Keyboard-operable navigation and controls.
- Visible keyboard focus indicators.
- Sufficient text and interface contrast.
- Descriptive link and control labels.

- Captions for video and transcripts for audio content.
- Appropriate alternative text for meaningful images.
- Responsive layouts that preserve readable content and usable controls.

6. Research and Content Responsibility

Mental health content has been developed using reputable sources and presented in a non-stigmatizing, educational manner. Claims have been checked against reliable references, and sources have been credited where appropriate.

StoryCast distinguishes educational information from personal testimony and does not present fictional or AI-generated accounts as real experiences.

https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/schizophrenia

https://www.nimh.nih.gov/health/topics/schizophrenia